



Yonah

What is Yonah?

Yonah is the next processor in the Pentium M Series of processors. It is a dual-core CPU unit manufactured using the industry's latest 65 nano meter silicone chip manufacturing process.

Who is making it?

Well, Intel Inc., only the largest chip manufacturer in the world! However, what's significant here is that Yonah is the first dual-core chip Intel has designed from scratch.

Where will it be used?

Yonah will be targeted at laptops, and is the latest platform for the Pentium M and Celeron M series of processors.

When will it be released?

Yonah-based mobile devices are expected to start shipping from early 2006. So expect to see dual-core computing on a laptop as early as mid-2006.

Why is Yonah only 32-bit?

Mooly Eden, Vice President and General Manager Mobile Platforms, Intel, said that though the technology to create 64-bit cores exists, Yonah will still be a 32-bit core because the 64-bit market is yet to mature. So should we start by telling Microsoft to halt production of their Windows XP 64-bit operating system? We think not!

How will Yonah change things for you?

Yonah will bring raw processing power to mobile devices, and due to its Vanderpool Virtualization feature, which allows it to turn off one of the cores when not required, will still save on battery life. Expect to see clock speeds of around 2.2 GHz and bus speeds of 667 MHz. A single-core version will also be manufactured, along with a lower-end version for the Celeron M series.

allowing Skype to expand the customer base for its Voice over Internet Protocol (VoIP) services.

But what in the world could eBay want Skype for? Or is it just a buyout because everyone else seems to be doing it? Not quite. There does seem to be some method to the madness.

For instance, in addition to its current transaction-based fees, eBay could allow charge for



deals through a pay-per-call basis using Skype. And, for its part, Skype could make it much easier for customers to pay for its fee-based services through PayPal, the online payment service owned by eBay. Skype currently has 54 million members in 225 countries and territories, and is adding 150,000 new users each day.

By acquiring Skype, eBay hopes to improve communications between buyers and sellers by allowing them to speak with each other, according to a statement.

Buyers will gain an easy and quick way to talk to sellers and receive the information they need to buy items. Sellers, too, will benefit by being able to build relationships with customers and closing deals, the company said.

The founders of Skype, Niklas Zennstrom and Janus Friis, will both assume positions within eBay's executive team, said eBay President and CEO Meg Whitman.

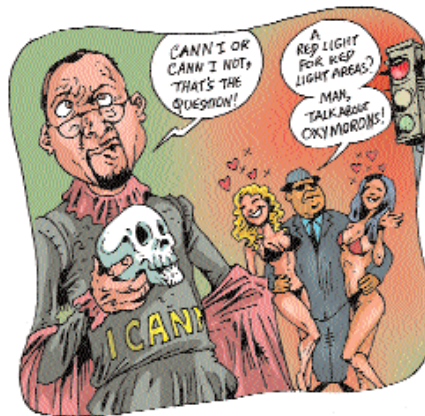
RED LIGHT FOR .XXX?

ICANN Dilly-dallies Implementation

ICANN, the overseers of the Internet, have apparently delayed the plan to set up a .xxx domain for pornographic sites. Ever since they announced their intentions to do this, there has been stiff resistance from politicians and citizens alike in the US. More the politicians, actually!

One of the major reasons being cited is that this would create a virtual red-light district on the Web. Certain

conservative groups have been pushing for the plan to be dropped because they fear it will lead to more porn (!) on the Web. Last month, the US government stepped in to hint strongly that it



didn't like the idea either. Big Brother has spoken!

On the whole, this plan has its positives, as we've spoken about earlier in this space. It would force the \$12 billion online porn industry to clean up its act. Those using the domain would have to abide by rules to stop spamming and malicious scripts, and the

whole lot could be blocked from kids by parents using parental control software. At least, that was the plan. Now, though, no one seems to know the fate of this 'domain'.

THE 'BEST' JUST GOT BETTER

Opera Goes Free

September 20, Opera Software removed the ad banner and licensing fee for good from its award-winning browser. The ad-free, full-featured Opera is now available for download completely free of charge at www.opera.com

According a press release from Oslo, Norway, CEO of Opera Software Jon S von Tetzchner said, "Today we invite the entire Internet community to use Opera and experience Web browsing as it should be.

"Removing the ad banner and licensing fee will encourage many new users to discover the speed, security and unmatched usability of the Opera browser."

Von Tetzchner added,

"Opera fans around the globe made this day possible.

"As we grow our userbase, our mission and our promise remain steadfast: we will always offer the best Internet experience to our users—on any device."

Opera is one of the most popular Web

browsers, and many consider it to be the best browser out there.

While the jury is still out on that one (some believe Firefox is better), the user base will sure rise now that the browser's ad-free to boot! ☐

Compiled by Aditya Kuber, Mithun Kidambi, Ram Mohan Rao and Renuka Rane